

CASE BRIEF – OPERATION TEAHOUSE

Case Designation:	Operation Teahouse
Region:	Macau / Hong Kong (Portuguese administration, PRC border)
Classification:	Secret – CL 2+
Issuing Division:	Wayfinder – Research Wing
Date:	[Current Date]

SITUATION

A Covenant watch-list artifact designated "**Bodhidharma's Teacup**" (see attached Relic Summary) has surfaced at a black-market auction in Macau. The artifact is a 6th-century stoneware cup that transmutes any liquid it contacts into a lethal, undetectable toxin. Liquid retains all physical properties – the poison cannot be seen, smelled, or tasted. The cup is being auctioned by a Macau-based broker. Confirmed bidders include a foreign extremist organization and a multinational pharmaceutical corporation.

OBJECTIVES

- Primary:** Recover the cup before the auction closes. Contain in a Keep vault under standard Tier 2 protocols.
- Secondary:** Identify all bidders and prevent any party from taking possession.
- Tertiary:** Locate the last surviving guardian of the cup (a former Shaolin monk) and determine whether a restoration or neutralization ritual exists.

KNOWN ORGANIZATIONS

ORGANIZATION	POSTURE	ASSESSMENT
The Broker – João Rosário	Active – running the auction	Former Covenant informant. Unreliable but not hostile. The cup was in his wall safe for two nights – he has not slept properly since.
Al-Quds Liberation Front	Active – bidder	Fictional extremist group. \$4.2M bid. Cell leader is inexperienced. The cell's second-in-command appears more committed.

Daewon Pharmaceutical	Active – bidder	Seoul-based. \$7M bid. They believe the poison mechanism can be isolated to cure infectious disease and cancer.
The Monk – Shi Yánxìn	Active – searching independently	Last guardian. 74 years old. Former Shaolin novice – hid the cup from Red Guards in 1966. May know how to neutralize it.
Macau Judiciary Police	Not yet involved	Will investigate if auction becomes public or if violence occurs in Macau territory.
Chinese State Security	Not yet active	Monitoring the Hong Kong dealer. May intervene if the cup is identified as stolen cultural property.

INITIAL LEADS

1. **Banco de Macau (L1):** The cup is in a safety deposit box on Avenida de Almeida Ribeiro. Confirm the location and assess access options.
2. **Rosário's Antique Shop (L2):** The broker's shop on Rua de São Paulo. Rosário has auction records, a wall safe, and a complicated history with the Covenant.
3. **The Tea House (L3):** A Macanese tea house on Travessa da Paixão. Rosário uses it for private viewings. The cup was shown here recently – a plant in the viewing room is dead.
4. **Camões Garden (L6):** Every morning, an old monk feeds pigeons near the grotto. He's been doing this for three weeks. He may know something about the cup.

OPERATIONAL PARAMETERS

- **Rules of Engagement:** Standard artifact recovery with extreme caution. Do not let the cup touch liquid. Handle only by the outer surface, with gloves. If the cup contacts any liquid – including sweat, condensation, or rain – that liquid becomes lethal. The cup's inner surface must stay dry at all times.
- **Bidder Protocol:** The pharmaceutical company is not hostile but is reckless – they do not understand what they are buying. The terrorist cell is inexperienced but desperate. Neither should be engaged as combatants unless they initiate.
- **Monk Protocol:** Shi Yánxìn is an ally. Treat him as such. He has been searching for the cup for 13 years. He knows more about it than anyone alive.
- **Containment Precaution:** The cup must be stored upside-down (mouth downward) during transport. Under no circumstances should the interior of the cup come into contact with any liquid.

REGIONAL CONTACTS

CONTACT	LOCATION	ACCESS
Inspector Matias Guterres, Macau Judiciary Police	Macau	Civilian law enforcement. Can be brought in if the situation escalates. Methodical and honest.
Sister Maria Cheng, Macau Catholic Diocese	Macau	Runs a shelter near the Inner Harbour. Knew Rosário from his seminary days. Can provide background on the broker.
Mr. Kwok, Hong Kong Antiquities Dealers Association	Hong Kong	Can trace the original looter and the cup's path from Henan to Macau.

This briefing contains information classified at Clearance Level 2. Distribution outside the assigned cell requires Watch Commander authorization. The artifact summary attached is a field estimate only – full Relic Sheet is DA-access.